

Human Resources English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: HR business partners, recruiters, talent managers, people managers, employee-relations staff, learning teams, compensation analysts, and HR-adjacent leaders

Focus: A human-resources English curriculum for hiring, onboarding, performance feedback, employee relations, investigations, benefits, compensation, policy explanation, workplace conflict, and dignity-preserving directness.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Recruiting, Screening, and Candidate Experience

Situation

A hiring manager rejects candidates for not feeling like a fit.

Stakeholder pressure: Use the manager's intuition.

Constraint: Selection criteria, interview evidence, bias risk, and documentation need clarity.

Terms to use

- job requirement
- structured interview
- bias
- candidate experience

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A hiring manager rejects candidates for not feeling like a fit.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Use the manager's intuition.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects structured interview.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a candidate-debrief guide.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects structured interview.

Option	Phrase
A	candidate experience
B	evidence threshold
C	job requirement
D	bias

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Use the manager's intuition.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	We should act now and resolve job requirement after the result is visible.
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify job requirement and structured interview against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A hiring manager rejects candidates for not feeling like a fit. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the candidate-debrief guide with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 2. Onboarding and Role Clarity

Situation

A new employee is confused about ownership after two weeks.

Stakeholder pressure: Tell them to be more proactive.

Constraint: Role scope, manager check-ins, training, and success measures may be unclear.

Terms to use

- role clarity
- onboarding
- manager check-in
- success measure

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A new employee is confused about ownership after two weeks.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Tell them to be more proactive.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects onboarding.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a onboarding reset plan.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects onboarding.

Option	Phrase
A	manager check-in
B	success measure
C	role clarity
D	onboarding

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Tell them to be more proactive.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	We should act now and resolve role clarity after the result is visible.
B	A onboarding reset plan is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
C	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify role clarity and onboarding against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A new employee is confused about ownership after two weeks. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the onboarding reset plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
D	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Module 3. Performance Feedback and Documentation

Situation

A manager wants to put an employee on a warning after months of vague concerns.

Stakeholder pressure: Issue the warning immediately.

Constraint: The employee may not have received clear expectations, examples, or support.

Terms to use

- performance gap
- documentation
- expectation

- support plan

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A manager wants to put an employee on a warning after months of vague concerns.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Issue the warning immediately.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects documentation.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a performance feedback script.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects documentation.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	performance gap
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Issue the warning immediately.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify performance gap and documentation against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	We should act now and resolve performance gap after the result is visible.
C	A performance feedback script is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
D	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A manager wants to put an employee on a warning after months of vague concerns. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
B	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
C	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Option	Phrase
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the performance feedback script with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 4. Employee Relations and Investigations

Situation

An employee reports harassment by a high performer.

Stakeholder pressure: Resolve it quietly because the accused is important.

Constraint: Investigation process, anti-retaliation, evidence, and confidentiality are critical.

Terms to use

- employee relations
- harassment
- retaliation
- confidentiality

Three-step decision practice

Situation

An employee reports harassment by a high performer.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Resolve it quietly because the accused is important.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects harassment.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a investigation intake summary.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects harassment.

Option	Phrase
A	employee relations
B	confidentiality
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Resolve it quietly because the accused is important.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A investigation intake summary is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify employee relations and harassment against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	We should act now and resolve employee relations after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - An employee reports harassment by a high performer. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the investigation intake summary with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
C	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Module 5. Compensation, Benefits, and Equity

Situation

An employee says a peer is paid more for the same job.

Stakeholder pressure: Promise an immediate adjustment.

Constraint: Pay bands, job leveling, equity review, budget, and communication process matter.

Terms to use

- pay band
- job level
- equity review
- benefits

Three-step decision practice

Situation

An employee says a peer is paid more for the same job.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Promise an immediate adjustment.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects job level.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a compensation response.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects job level.

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	pay band
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Promise an immediate adjustment.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	We should act now and resolve pay band after the result is visible.
B	A compensation response is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
C	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify pay band and job level against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - An employee says a peer is paid more for the same job. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the compensation response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
D	evidence threshold

Module 6. Policy Communication and Compliance

Situation

A manager wants to make an exception to leave policy.

Stakeholder pressure: Approve it because the employee is valued.

Constraint: Consistency, accommodation, legal risk, and manager precedent need review.

Terms to use

- policy
- accommodation
- precedent

- compliance

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A manager wants to make an exception to leave policy.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Approve it because the employee is valued.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects accommodation.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a policy exception review.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects accommodation.

Option	Phrase
A	policy
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Approve it because the employee is valued.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	We should act now and resolve policy after the result is visible.
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify policy and accommodation against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A manager wants to make an exception to leave policy. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the policy exception review with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Option	Phrase
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

Module 7. Conflict Mediation and Manager Coaching

Situation

Two team leads accuse each other of blocking work.

Stakeholder pressure: Move one of them to another team.

Constraint: Shared expectations, facts, behavior, and operating agreements should be tested first.

Terms to use

- mediation
- behavioral example
- operating agreement
- accountability

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Two team leads accuse each other of blocking work.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Move one of them to another team.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects behavioral example.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a mediation opening script.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects behavioral example.

Option	Phrase
A	mediation
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	behavioral example

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Move one of them to another team.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A mediation opening script is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify mediation and behavioral example against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	We should act now and resolve mediation after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Two team leads accuse each other of blocking work. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the mediation opening script with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 8. Restructuring and Sensitive Communication

Situation

Leadership plans a reorg but wants managers to hint at it early.

Stakeholder pressure: Give employees informal warnings.

Constraint: Timing, confidentiality, legal review, messaging, and dignity are essential.

Terms to use

- restructuring
- position elimination
- severance
- talking points

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Leadership plans a reorg but wants managers to hint at it early.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Give employees informal warnings.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects position elimination.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a reorg communication checklist.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects position elimination.

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	restructuring

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Give employees informal warnings.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A reorg communication checklist is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify restructuring and position elimination against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	We should act now and resolve restructuring after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Leadership plans a reorg but wants managers to hint at it early. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the reorg communication checklist with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
D	evidence threshold

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

Recruiting, Screening, and Candidate Experience - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. job requirement	'job requirement' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Recruiting, Screening, and Candidate Experience - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify job requirement and structured interview against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Recruiting, Screening, and Candidate Experience - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the candidate-debrief guide with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Onboarding and Role Clarity - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. role clarity	'role clarity' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Onboarding and Role Clarity - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify role clarity and onboarding against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Onboarding and Role Clarity - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the onboarding reset plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Performance Feedback and Documentation - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. performance gap	'performance gap' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Performance Feedback and Documentation - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify performance gap and documentation against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Performance Feedback and Documentation - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the performance feedback script with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Employee Relations and Investigations - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. employee relations	'employee relations' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Employee Relations and Investigations - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify employee relations and harassment against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Employee Relations and Investigations - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the investigation intake summary with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Compensation, Benefits, and Equity - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. pay band	'pay band' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Compensation, Benefits, and Equity - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify pay band and job level against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Compensation, Benefits, and Equity - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the compensation response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Policy Communication and Compliance - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. policy	'policy' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Policy Communication and Compliance - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify policy and accommodation against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Policy Communication and Compliance - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the policy exception review with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Conflict Mediation and Manager Coaching - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. mediation	'mediation' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Conflict Mediation and Manager Coaching - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify mediation and behavioral example against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Conflict Mediation and Manager Coaching - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the mediation opening script with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Restructuring and Sensitive Communication - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. restructuring	'restructuring' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Restructuring and Sensitive Communication - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify restructuring and position elimination against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Restructuring and Sensitive Communication - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the reorg communication checklist with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.